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Outlook for October-November-December (OND), 2026

1. Current Meteorological Conditions

During the July–September (JAS) 2026 season, rainfall remained predominantly below normal across the country. The rainfall observed in Punjab and Gilgit-Baltistan, however, remained close to the climatological record. The southern half of the country experienced predominantly below-normal rainfall, with Sindh recording significantly deficient rainfall during the season. Following the onset of the summer monsoon on 1st July, multiple rainfall spells of moderate to heavy intensity affected various parts of the country, particularly the northern regions. Isolated episodes of heavy rainfall triggered flash and urban flooding in low-lying areas of Punjab, Azad Jammu and Kashmir, and Khyber Pakhtunkhwa. A notable rainfall spell during the first week of August affected most parts of Sindh and the southern parts of Balochistan. However, no significant rainfall spells occurred thereafter, resulting in prolonged dry conditions over these regions. Temperatures during JAS 2026 remained predominantly above normal across most parts of Pakistan, while Gilgit-Baltistan experienced near-normal temperatures during the season. The largest positive seasonal temperature anomalies were observed over Balochistan, followed by Sindh (**Table 1**).

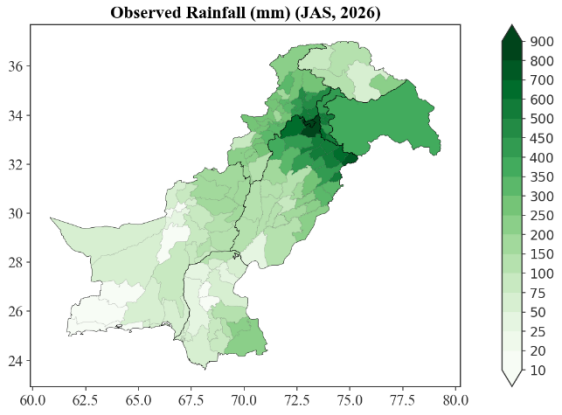


Figure 1: Observed rainfall (mm), JAS 2026

Table 1: Summary of the JAS 2026 Observed Rainfall and Temperature

Region	Total Rainfall (mm)	Normal* Rainfall (mm)	Rainfall Departure (%)	Mean Temp (°C)	Anomaly (°C)
Pakistan	120.5	149.2	-19.3	29.0	1.0
AJK	302.8	371.3	-18.4	23.1	0.6
Balochistan	39.1	58.9	-33.7	29.5	1.4
Gilgit-Baltistan	54.1	51.8	4.6	21.3	0.3
Khyber Pakhtunkhwa	226.7	270.9	-16.3	26.1	0.5
Punjab	241.4	251	-3.8	30.5	0.6
Sindh	71.1	144.3	-50.8	31.7	1.1

* Normal Period (1991 – 2020)

2. Seasonal Rainfall Outlook:

The seasonal outlook is prepared using the forecasts of 10 selected global climate models, exhibiting relatively high predictive skill. The model outputs are integrated using the Multi-Model Ensemble (MME) technique, resulting in an operational outlook for seasonal rainfall and temperature. Currently, the Indian Ocean Dipole (IOD) is in a positive phase and is expected to shift to its neutral phase at the end of the OND season. Likewise, the current positive phase of the El Niño–Southern Oscillation (ENSO) is expected to persist throughout the season. Based on the prevailing climatic conditions, the forecast indicates a general tendency for **normal to above-normal*** rainfall in most parts of the country during October to December (OND) 2026. The forecast indicates a pronounced positive anomaly concentrated over northwestern regions, with the highest anomalies expected across central to northern Khyber Pakhtunkhwa and adjoining areas of Gilgit-Baltistan, Kashmir, and northern Punjab. Near normal to slightly below normal rainfall is anticipated across central to southern parts of the country with weak negative anomalies expected over southern parts of Sindh (**Figures 2 and 3**).

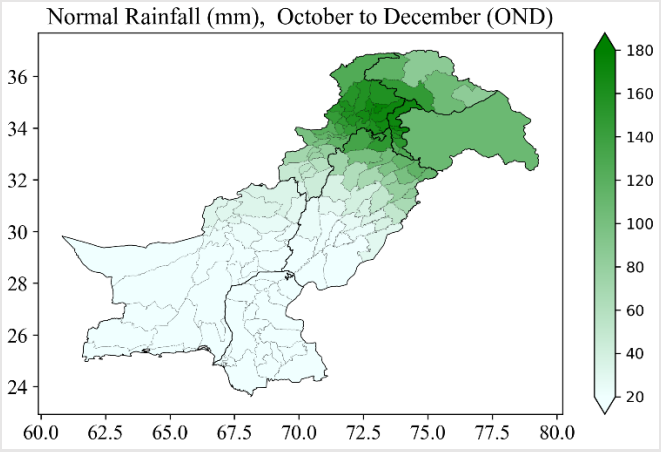


Figure 2: Normal (1991-2020) rainfall (mm) for OND

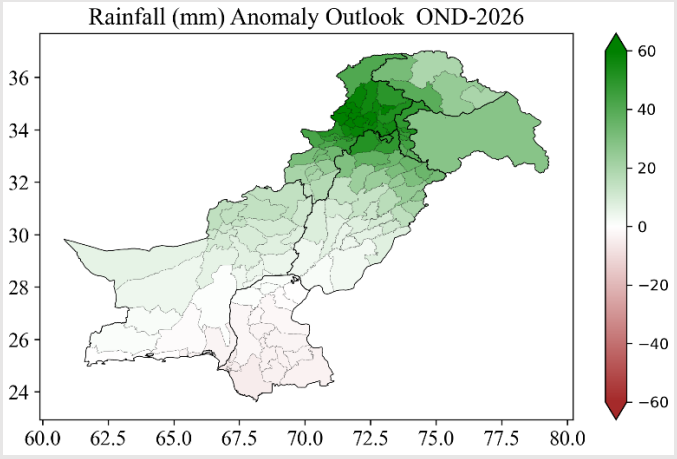


Figure 3: Seasonal rainfall (mm) anomaly for OND 2026

The probabilistic outlook represents the combined agreement of all models included in the ensemble. The tercile probability output (**Figure 4**) indicates a higher likelihood of **above-normal*** rainfall across northern Pakistan, particularly Gilgit-Baltistan, Kashmir, northern Khyber Pakhtunkhwa, and the western hilly areas of the country. In contrast, near-normal rainfall is more likely across central and southern parts of Pakistan, including southern Punjab, Sindh, and southern Balochistan, during OND 2026.

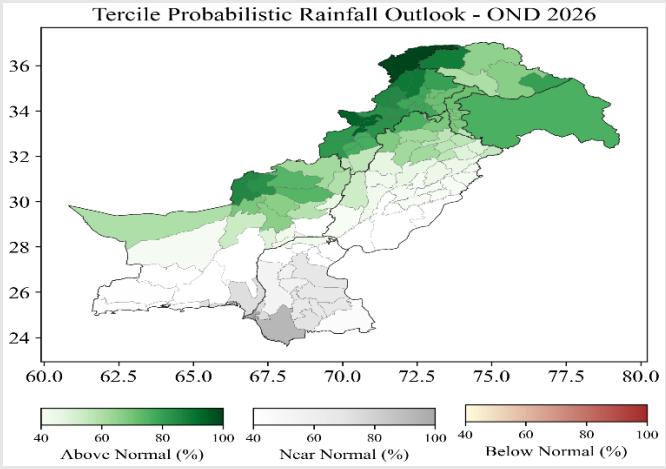


Figure 4: Probabilistic (%) rainfall outlook for OND 2026

* Normal = 30-years average climatology

3. Seasonal Temperature Outlook:

Mean temperatures are expected to remain **above normal**[*] over most parts of the country. However, Gilgit-Baltistan, northern Khyber Pakhtunkhwa, Kashmir and western parts of Balochistan may experience above normal temperature during OND 2026 **(Figure 5, 6)**.

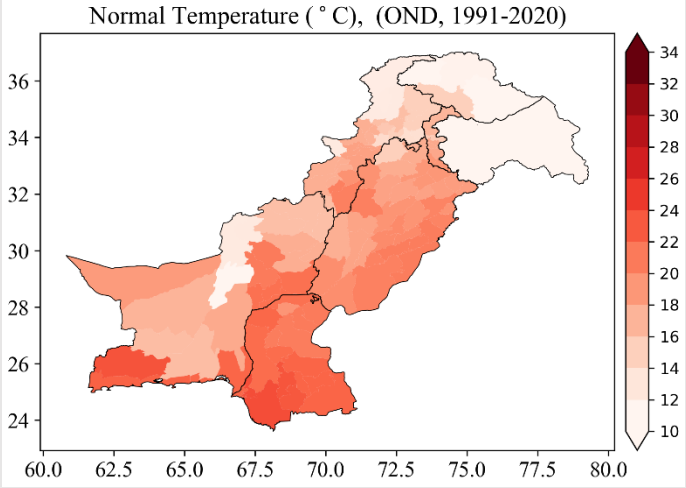


Figure 5: Normal (1991 - 2020) temperature for OND

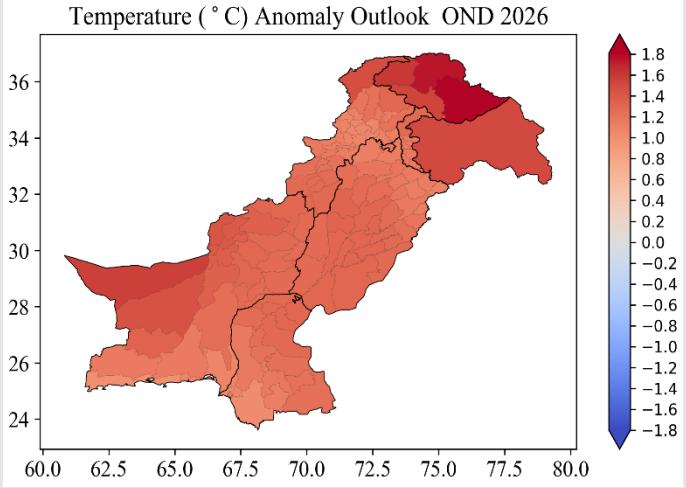


Figure 6: Seasonal temperature anomaly outlook for OND 2026

The tercile probabilistic temperature outlook **(Figure 7)** reflects a predominant model consensus for above-normal temperatures across Pakistan during OND 2026, with the highest probabilities over Gilgit-Baltistan and adjoining northern parts of Khyber Pakhtunkhwa.

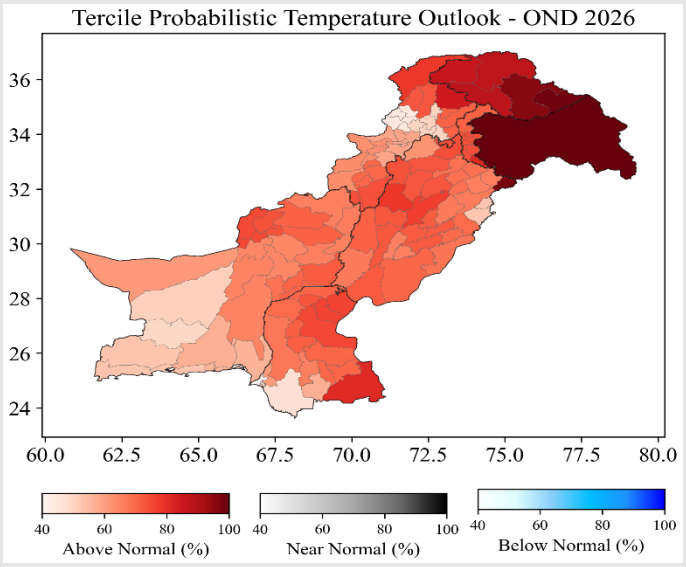


Figure 7: Probabilistic (%) temperature outlook for OND 2026

[*] Normal = 30-years average climatology

4. **Impacts:**

- **Agricultural Advisory:**
  - Isolated showers, hailstorms, or windstorms mainly during October may disrupt Kharif harvesting and post-harvest activities, particularly in northwestern regions. Farmers are advised to take precautionary measures to minimize potential damage.
  - Favorable rainfall conditions in northwestern regions may support timely Rabi sowing, while dryer conditions in southern regions may increase irrigation requirements during the early Rabi season.

- **Air Quality:**
  - Near to below normal rainfall in central to southern Pakistan, may lead to an increased risk of fog and smog formation in plain areas, potentially resulting in deteriorated air quality and associated impacts on human health and visibility.

- **Public Health and Wellbeing:**
  - Dengue transmission may remain active during October and November, particularly in warmer and humid urban areas, but is expected to decline towards December. Preventive measures, including vector control and removal of stagnant water, should be strengthened to reduce dengue transmission.

- **Snowmelt, Avalanches**
  - Above-normal temperatures in Gilgit-Baltistan, northern Khyber Pakhtunkhwa and Kashmir may delay snow accumulation at lower elevations, while snowfall at higher elevations may gradually establish seasonal snow cover.
  - Periods of snowfall and rainfall in high-altitude areas, particularly from November onward, may contribute to unstable snowpack conditions and localized avalanches, especially in steep and vulnerable terrain.

Note: The Seasonal Outlook is updated monthly in the first week of the month. The forecast reliability varies with location, time of year, and global ocean/atmospheric conditions. It provides general trends using probabilities rather than precise predictions and compares expected conditions to historical averages. For better decision-making, it should be used alongside short-term forecasts and other climate data issued by PMD.